QR-Code Phishing (Quishing) Research Dataset Guide

Public research sources for defensive detection, model testing, and hackathon evaluation

Purpose. This guide identifies public research datasets that contain more than 1,000 QR-code or URL samples relevant to malicious-QR detection. To reduce accidental exposure to active phishing or malware destinations, this PDF catalogs trusted research sources rather than embedding a bulk collection of live malicious QR payloads.

Dataset sources

CIC-Trap4Phish 2025 — Canadian Institute for Cybersecurity

Research benchmark covering multiple attachment types, including a QR-code subset reported as 1,000,000 images (430,000 benign and 575,000 malicious). Designed for offline defensive detection research.

https://www.unb.ca/cic/datasets/trap4phish2025.html

Detect-Quishing-Attacks — GitHub

Research repository reports 9,987 QR-code samples represented as 69×69 arrays, with labels for phishing versus benign. Review the repository documentation and license before use.

https://github.com/n33r9/Detect-Quishing-Attacks

Mobile QR Scanner Quishing Dataset — GitHub

An empirical study dataset reporting 1,000 URLs: 850 phishing and 150 benign. Useful for evaluating scanner detection behavior; verify current availability and research terms.

https://github.com/Hyphen-14/quishing-scanner-empirical-study-dataset

Dataset of 1,000 Images of Malicious and Benign QR Codes — Mendeley Data

A research dataset described as 500 malicious and 500 benign QR-code images. Confirm dataset version, access terms, and source documentation before using.

https://data.mendeley.com/research-data/?query=CPCB+waste+management+QR+Code

BanglaQR-Quish — Mendeley Data

Synthetic dataset described as 50,000 QR images (25,000 benign and 25,000 malicious-style samples) for payment-QR detection research. It is synthetic, not a live threat feed.

https://data.mendeley.com/datasets/pz95pr8pyd/1

Safe handling checklist

• Download datasets only from the official repository or publisher page; review its license and README.

• Do not scan or open embedded destinations on a personal phone or everyday computer.

• Decode QR images offline in an isolated analysis environment; keep network access disabled where possible.

• Store labels, source URLs, collection dates, and hashes as metadata so results can be reproduced.

• For live threat intelligence, verify indicators against current reputation services; malicious URLs can expire or change ownership.

• Do not redistribute active phishing links or payloads publicly. Share defanged indicators or controlled research references instead.

Suggested project workflow

Stage	What to do
1. Source	Choose a dataset with a clear license and provenance.
2. Label	Keep benign/phishing labels and the original dataset's label definitions.
3. Decode safely	Extract QR payloads offline; do not visit decoded URLs.
4. Detect	Test URL lexical features, domain reputation, redirects, and QR-image features.
5. Evaluate	Report precision, recall, false-positive rate, and a held-out test split.

Note: Dataset sizes and descriptions above are taken from the cited public pages and may change. This guide does not itself contain 1,000 QR images or certify that every sample is currently malicious; verify details with each dataset maintainer.